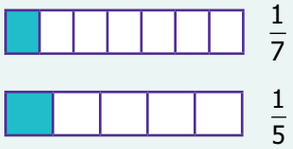
Comparison of Unit Fractions: ***Unit fractions*** are fractions having 1 as its numerator. For example compare $\frac{1}{7}$ and $\frac{1}{5}$. One can conclude that $\frac{1}{5} > \frac{1}{7}$ by observing the diagram. So, in unit fraction the larger the denominator the smaller will be the fraction. Hence, we conclude that if the numerators are the same in two fractions, the fraction with the smaller denominator is greater of the two.



Try these

1. Shade the rectangle for the given pair of fractions and say which is greater among them.

i) $\frac{1}{3}$ and $\frac{1}{5}$		ii) $\frac{2}{5}$ and $\frac{5}{8}$	
Shade $\frac{1}{3}$	Shade $\frac{1}{5}$	Shade $\frac{2}{5}$	Shade $\frac{5}{8}$
			
$\frac{1}{3}$ is _____ than $\frac{1}{5}$. That is $\frac{1}{3}$ _____ $\frac{1}{5}$.		$\frac{2}{5}$ is _____ than $\frac{5}{8}$. That is $\frac{2}{5}$ _____ $\frac{5}{8}$.	

2. Which is greater $\frac{3}{8}$ or $\frac{3}{5}$?
3. Arrange the fractions in ascending order: $\frac{3}{5}, \frac{9}{10}, \frac{11}{15}$
4. Arrange the fractions in descending order: $\frac{9}{20}, \frac{3}{4}, \frac{7}{12}$

1.3 Addition and Subtraction of Unlike Fractions

Think about the situation

Venkat went to buy milk. He bought $\frac{1}{2}$ litre first and then he bought $\frac{1}{4}$ litre. He wanted to find how much milk he bought altogether? In order to find the total quantity of milk, he has to add $\frac{1}{2}$ and $\frac{1}{4}$. That is $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}$. To add or subtract two unlike fractions, first we need to convert them into like fractions.

Example 5 The teacher had given the same situation mentioned above and asked two students Ravi and Arun to solve it. They came out with the answers for $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{4}$.

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